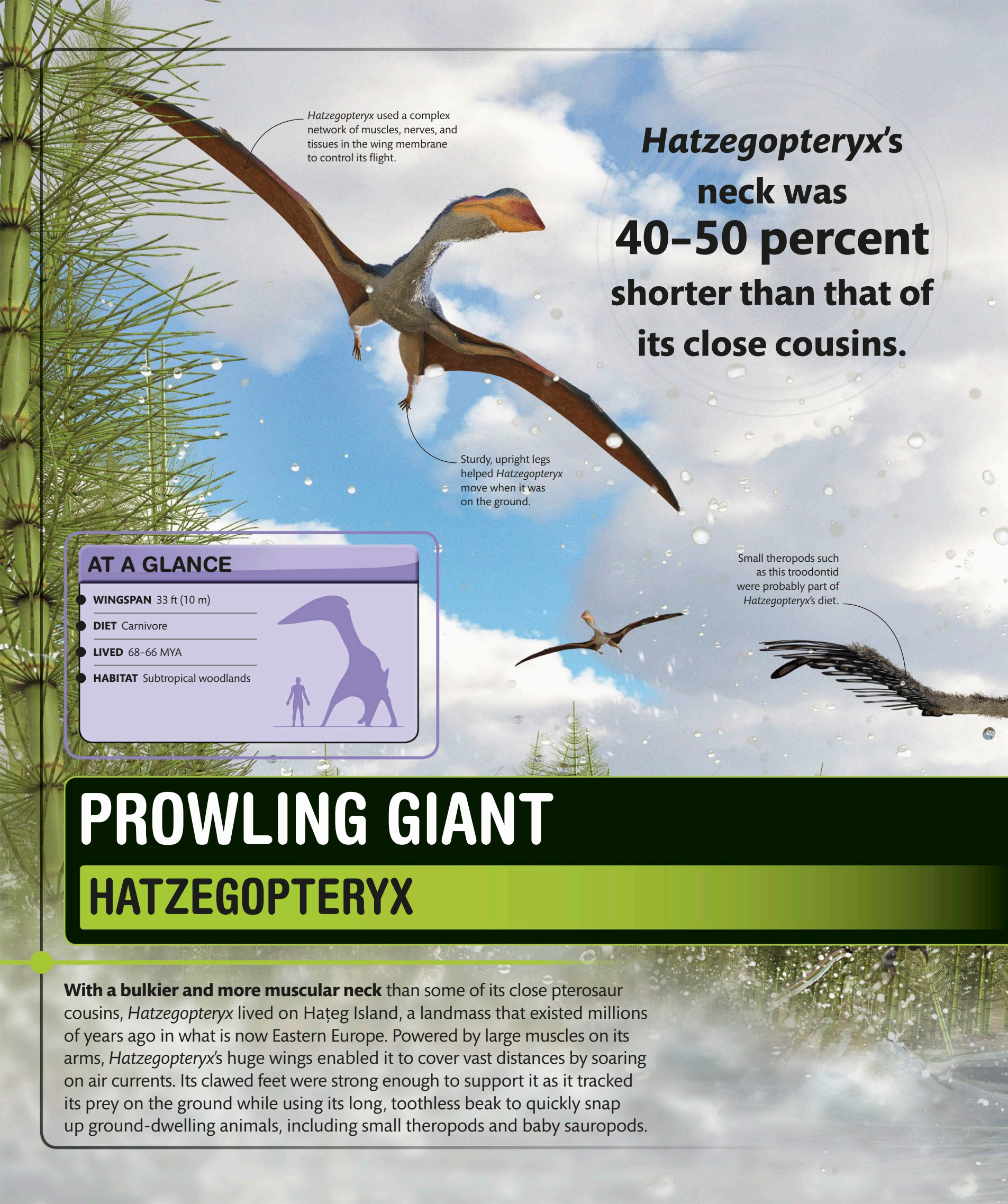




Hatzegopteryx used a complex network of muscles, nerves, and tissues in the wing membrane to control its flight.

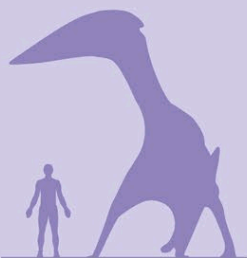
***Hatzegopteryx*'s neck was 40–50 percent shorter than that of its close cousins.**

Sturdy, upright legs helped *Hatzegopteryx* move when it was on the ground.

Small theropods such as this troodontid were probably part of *Hatzegopteryx*'s diet.

AT A GLANCE

- **WINGSPAN** 33 ft (10 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 68–66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Subtropical woodlands



PROWLING GIANT

HATZEGOPTERYX

With a bulkier and more muscular neck than some of its close pterosaur cousins, *Hatzegopteryx* lived on Hațeg Island, a landmass that existed millions of years ago in what is now Eastern Europe. Powered by large muscles on its arms, *Hatzegopteryx*'s huge wings enabled it to cover vast distances by soaring on air currents. Its clawed feet were strong enough to support it as it tracked its prey on the ground while using its long, toothless beak to quickly snap up ground-dwelling animals, including small theropods and baby sauropods.